

1 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Fill the ten-frame

What we are practising

Represent a number and find how many more make ten.

What you need

Paper / Crayons

An adult draws while the child points.

Before you begin

Draw a rectangle split into two rows of five boxes.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Draw dots in the first six boxes, filling the top row first.
2. Count the filled boxes and then the empty ones.
3. Add enough dots to fill the frame and check the total.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How does a full row help you see six?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

The picture-price shop

What we are practising

Add quantities within ten and compare them with a limit.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use tally marks instead of numerals.

Before you begin

Draw an apple costing 2 points, a book 3 and a ball 4; prices are imaginary.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Choose the apple and book and draw two dots beside three.
2. Count their total and compare it with ten available points.
3. Add the ball and check the new total and remaining points.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How many points remain after buying all three?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Measure with a paper strip

What we are practising

Measure length with equal units and no gaps or overlaps.

What you need

Short paper strip prepared by an adult / Pencil / Book / Paper

Use identical large blocks end to end.

Before you begin

Choose a book roughly three or four strip-lengths long.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Align a strip end with the book's edge and mark its far end on paper alongside.
2. Move the strip to start at that mark and repeat without gaps.
3. Count full units and describe any leftover length.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What if we leave spaces between units?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Share six picnic sandwiches

What we are practising

Make equal groups and check each group's size.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use six large blocks and three drawn places.

Before you begin

Draw three guests and six sandwiches in a separate row.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Give each guest one sandwich by drawing a connecting line.
2. Repeat until all six are shared.
3. Count each guest's share and explain how you know it is equal.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Are shares of three, two and one equal?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Fold-and-check butterflies

What we are practising

Explore reflection symmetry around a central line.

What you need

Paper / Crayons

Match hand positions across a drawn line.

Before you begin

Fold paper in half, reopen it and draw a body on the crease.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Draw one broad wing on each side.
2. Add a large spot to one wing and a matching spot on the other.
3. Fold again and hold towards room light to compare approximate positions.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How far from the fold should each spot be?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Fill the ten-frame

A little hint

A full row is five; six is five and one more.

Answer / what to notice

Six filled spaces leave four empty; six and four make ten.

The frame shows the relationship between a number and ten.

Make it easier

Use one row of five with three dots.

Take it further

Choose another starting number and predict its missing part.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw ten windows and colour some as lit windows.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. The picture-price shop

A little hint

Cross out one of ten drawn points for each point spent.

Answer / what to notice

Apple and book cost 5; all three cost 9, leaving 1 from 10.

The total shows spending; comparing it with ten shows what remains.

Make it easier

Buy two items priced at 1 and 2.

Take it further

Choose repeated items to spend exactly ten points.

Another day, away from the screen

Invent another shop with prices up to five.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Measure with a paper strip

A little hint

Each new position starts where the last ended.

Answer / what to notice

The number depends on both lengths; describe a remainder as “and a little more”.

Keeping the unit size fixed makes measurements comparable.

Make it easier

Lay equal strips end to end instead of moving one.

Take it further

Measure again using a shorter unit and compare the count.

Another day, away from the screen

Estimate another book before measuring it.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Share six picnic sandwiches

A little hint

Compare the guests' numbers, not just the total.

Answer / what to notice

Each guest gets two; three, two and one would be unequal.

Sharing one at a time helps keep the groups equal.

Make it easier

Share four items between two guests.

Take it further

Share seven whole items between three and identify the remainder.

Another day, away from the screen

Share drawing tools equally for a joint picture.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Fold-and-check butterflies

A little hint

Match height and distance from the middle.

Answer / what to notice

Matching features lie on opposite sides at equal distances from the fold; approximate drawings are fine.

Reflection reverses sides while preserving distance from the central line.

Make it easier

Match just one spot per wing.

Take it further

Add a second pair of differently shaped markings.

Another day, away from the screen

Find an approximately symmetrical household object.